

VelocityX Ecommerce Warranty, Returns & Exchange Policy

Internal Customer Service Reference Guide

Document Type: Internal Operations Policy

Audience: Customer Service, Escalations, Marketplace Support, Warehouse Coordination Teams

Version: 1.0

Applies To: Ecommerce purchases made through VelocityX owned digital channels and approved regional storefronts

1. Purpose

This policy provides a standardized framework for handling customer calls, chats, emails, and complaints related to:

- product warranty
- returns
- exchanges
- damaged or defective items
- wrong item deliveries
- size and fit issues
- region-specific ecommerce fulfillment matters

The objective is to ensure that every customer receives a fair, consistent, brand-aligned resolution while protecting the company from misuse and policy abuse.

2. Brand Positioning and Service Philosophy

VelocityX is a performance-led sports footwear and active gear brand. Our customer service approach should reflect the brand personality:

- confident
- fast-moving
- fair
- athlete-first
- solution-oriented

When handling complaints, agents should aim to:

- resolve with clarity
 - avoid unnecessary friction
 - distinguish between genuine quality issues and normal wear and tear
 - protect customer trust without overcommitting beyond policy
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3. Scope

This policy applies to ecommerce orders purchased through:

- VelocityX official website
- VelocityX official mobile app
- approved regional direct-to-consumer storefronts
- officially operated brand marketplaces where VelocityX controls fulfillment and customer support

This policy does **not automatically apply** to:

- purchases from unauthorized sellers
 - third-party resellers not designated by VelocityX
 - marketplace sellers not fulfilled by VelocityX
 - purchases made in physical retail stores, unless specifically stated in the regional appendix
 - B2B, team, school, institutional, distributor, or bulk orders unless contractually covered
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4. Product Categories Covered

The following categories are supported under this policy:

4.1 Footwear

- running shoes
- training shoes
- basketball shoes
- football boots
- turf shoes
- hiking shoes
- walking shoes
- lifestyle sneakers
- kids' sports shoes
- sandals, slides, and recovery footwear

4.2 Apparel

- t-shirts

- shorts
- track pants
- jackets
- leggings
- socks
- sports bras
- compression wear

4.3 Accessories

- caps
- bags
- insoles
- laces
- sleeves
- wristbands
- shoe care items

4.4 Limited or Special Products

- limited-edition drops
- collaboration products
- personalized/customized products
- team edition or tournament edition products

These may have separate rules, especially for returns and exchanges.

5. Key Definitions

5.1 Return

A customer sends the product back for a refund.

5.2 Exchange

A customer returns one item and receives a replacement item, typically for:

- size change
- color change, where permitted
- replacement of a damaged item
- replacement of a wrong item sent

5.3 Warranty Claim

A request made due to a manufacturing defect or material failure within the stated warranty period.

5.4 Dead on Arrival (DOA)

A product received in unusable, damaged, or materially defective condition upon delivery or first inspection.

5.5 Manufacturing Defect

A fault arising from workmanship, material, assembly, bonding, stitching, sole adhesion, eyelet failure, zipper failure, or component failure not caused by misuse or normal wear.

5.6 Normal Wear and Tear

Expected deterioration from regular usage over time, including:

- sole wear from use
- fading from washing or sun exposure
- fabric stretching from regular use
- creasing in footwear uppers
- minor glue marks not affecting performance
- outsole abrasion from road or court friction

5.7 Hygiene-Sensitive Products

Products with restricted return eligibility after use for hygiene reasons.

6. Policy Hierarchy

If there is a conflict between policies, agents should apply them in this order:

1. local consumer law
2. regional VelocityX ecommerce policy
3. promotion-specific terms
4. product-specific exclusion terms
5. standard global policy

If unsure, escalate before denying a claim.

7. Proof of Purchase Requirements

A customer must usually provide one of the following:

- order number
- registered email address
- phone number used for the purchase
- invoice or digital receipt
- shipment confirmation

For warranty claims, supporting photos or videos may also be required.

If proof of purchase cannot be found, agents may:

- search internal systems
 - verify via payment reference, delivery address, or customer account
 - escalate for exception handling if the customer is credible and the product appears authentic
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8. Standard Return Window

8.1 General Return Window

VelocityX offers a standard **30-day return window** from the date of delivery for eligible ecommerce purchases.

To qualify, products must generally be:

- unused or lightly tried on
- in resalable condition
- returned with original tags, labels, and packaging where reasonably possible

8.2 Extended Holiday / Promotional Windows

Certain seasons may include extended return windows, such as:

- holiday gifting periods
- new year campaigns
- marathon season events
- back-to-school promotions

Agents must always check the promotional rules tied to the order date.

9. Exchange Window

The standard exchange window is **30 days from delivery**, subject to stock availability.

Exchanges are usually permitted for:

- size issues
- wrong item received
- damaged on arrival
- verified manufacturing defect during early use

Color/style exchanges may be allowed only where supported by regional operations and inventory systems.

10. Warranty Coverage

10.1 Standard Warranty Period

Footwear

- **6 months** from delivery against manufacturing defects

Apparel

- **3 months** from delivery against manufacturing defects

Accessories

- **3 months** from delivery against manufacturing defects

Limited / performance-engineered premium footwear

- may carry category-specific warranty terms listed on product page or packaging

10.2 What Warranty Covers

Warranty generally covers:

- sole separation not caused by impact damage or misuse
- stitching failure under normal use
- eyelet breakage under normal lace tension
- upper material splitting due to faulty construction
- abnormal internal lining collapse shortly after purchase
- insole detachment due to adhesive failure
- broken hardware due to manufacturing fault
- defective zippers or closures
- asymmetrical build defects
- color transfer due to material fault, where verified

10.3 What Warranty Does Not Cover

Warranty does not cover:

- normal wear and tear
 - cosmetic issues reported after significant use
 - improper washing or drying
 - accidental damage
 - misuse or abusive use
 - sports use beyond product design intent
 - damage from external chemicals, mud curing, heat, or water immersion
 - odor complaints after use
 - poor fit or discomfort after extended usage where there is no manufacturing defect
 - modifications, repairs, or alterations by customer or third party
 - damage caused by pets
 - damage caused by storage neglect
 - products purchased from unauthorized channels
 - counterfeit items
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11. Return Eligibility Rules by Scenario

11.1 Eligible for Return

Customers may return products when:

- they changed their mind within the return window
- the size/fit is unsuitable
- they received the wrong item
- the product arrived damaged
- the product is materially different from the order
- there is a verified early-life defect
- the product was delivered incomplete or missing a pair/matching unit

11.2 Conditionally Eligible

Return may still be allowed with supervisor approval when:

- outer packaging is missing but product is unused
- tags are removed but item is clearly unworn
- one-time exception requested for loyal customer
- return window exceeded slightly due to delivery or pickup delays
- a gift recipient lacks invoice but order can be verified

11.3 Not Eligible

Return is generally not allowed for:

- visibly used products with no quality issue
 - mud-soiled, washed, or odor-bearing items returned as fit issues
 - items returned after the policy window without approved exception
 - personalized or customized items, unless defective
 - final sale / non-returnable promotional items
 - socks, undergarments, and other hygiene-sensitive products once opened, unless defective
 - digital goods, gift cards, and vouchers
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12. Category-Specific Return and Warranty Guidance

12.1 Running Shoes

Acceptable claims:

- bond failure
- premature seam failure
- outsole detachment unrelated to mileage abuse

Use caution for:

- outsole wear due to mileage
- cushioning compression after heavy running
- gait-related uneven wear
- discomfort claims after prolonged use

12.2 Football Boots / Turf Shoes

Not usually covered if damage is caused by:

- abrasive turf conditions
- stud wear from hard surfaces
- use on unsuitable ground type

Covered if:

- studs detach due to manufacturing issue
- upper tears at non-stress zones unusually early
- sole plate separates prematurely without impact misuse

12.3 Basketball Shoes

Not covered:

- scuffing from court play
- traction loss from heavy use
- ankle collar wear from repeated friction over time

Covered:

- sole separation
- lace loop failure
- structural panel delamination due to defect

12.4 Hiking / Outdoor Shoes

Not covered:

- water ingress unless explicitly marketed as waterproof and product has failed due to defect
- abrasion from rocky terrain
- toe cap damage from impact

Covered:

- membrane failure where verified
- bonding defects
- hook/lace hardware failure due to workmanship defect

12.5 Kids' Footwear

Exercise greater flexibility if:

- the issue is reported quickly
- the product is clearly barely used
- sizing mismatch resulted from confusing size chart or listing error

12.6 Apparel

Common covered issues:

- seam opening
- zipper failure
- print peeling unusually early due to defect
- incorrect labeling

Not covered:

- shrinkage from incorrect washing
- fading from repeated laundering
- pilling from friction
- odor after use

12.7 Accessories

Coverage depends on product type.

For example:

- bag zipper failure may be covered
 - lace breakage may be covered if early and abnormal
 - insoles may be replaced if defective on arrival
 - sweatband odor complaints are not warranty matters
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13. Regional Policy Differences

Regional teams must align with local law and logistics capability. The framework below sets default variations.

13.1 North America

- standard returns: 30 days
- free returns may be offered for full-price items
- prepaid return labels commonly available
- refunds typically processed to original payment method
- exchange may be handled as instant exchange or return-plus-repurchase depending on system

13.2 Europe / UK

- cooling-off rights may apply under local consumer laws
- return windows may vary by country
- customer must be informed of statutory rights separately from brand policy
- fault-based claims may receive broader legal protection in some markets
- refund timelines must comply with local regulations

13.3 India

- size exchanges may be widely expected
- reverse pickup feasibility depends on PIN code/serviceability
- some rural or non-serviceable zones may require self-ship returns
- cash on delivery refunds may be processed via bank transfer, wallet, or store credit depending on local system capability
- hygiene, packaging, and usage checks must be applied carefully but fairly

13.4 Middle East

- cross-border and customs-sensitive returns may have restrictions
- exchange may depend on import/export conditions

- refund timelines may vary due to payment gateway settlement rules
- Arabic/English support requirements may apply

13.5 Southeast Asia

- return logistics may differ by country
- marketplace-fulfilled orders may need platform-specific handling
- cross-border exchanges may not always be supported
- refund method depends on payment rails available locally

13.6 Latin America / Other Emerging Markets

- support may depend on country-specific ecommerce entity
 - customs and duty rules may affect return eligibility
 - local law may override standard global rules
 - self-ship or drop-off models may be more common than pickup
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14. Cross-Border Orders

For cross-border ecommerce orders:

- returns may be limited or unavailable unless item is defective or wrong
- original shipping fees, customs duties, and import charges may be non-refundable unless required by law
- exchange may not be operationally supported
- replacement may be issued only after return receipt or proof of destruction in special cases
- customers must be informed clearly before commitment

Escalate all cross-border exceptions.

15. Marketplace Orders

For orders placed on third-party marketplaces:

15.1 If VelocityX Controls Fulfillment and Support

Apply this policy unless marketplace terms override it.

15.2 If Marketplace Seller Controls Fulfillment

Customer should usually be redirected to the seller or marketplace support flow.

Agents should:

- verify seller identity
 - avoid promising direct warranty handling unless authorized
 - support brand authentication checks where applicable
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16. Non-Returnable / Restricted Items

The following are generally non-returnable unless defective, damaged, or wrongfully delivered:

- customized shoes
 - personalized products
 - engraved items
 - final clearance items marked non-returnable
 - opened socks or intimate wear
 - used shoe care liquids
 - gift cards
 - limited collectibles where stated
 - bundled free gifts, unless the main item is returned under full-order reversal rules
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17. Return Condition Standards

Agents should use the following condition framework:

17.1 New

Unused, original condition, tags and packaging intact.

17.2 Tried On Only

Indoor trial or minimal fitting signs, still eligible.

17.3 Lightly Used

May require supervisor approval depending on reason.

17.4 Heavily Used

Typically not returnable unless there is a valid warranty defect.

17.5 Damaged in Transit

Eligible for refund, replacement, or exchange.

17.6 Defective

Eligible subject to verification and timing.

18. Refund Rules

18.1 Refund Method

Refunds should generally be issued to the original payment method.

If not possible:

- store credit
 - replacement code
 - bank transfer
 - wallet refund
- may be used per regional process.

18.2 Shipping Charges

Shipping fee treatment depends on reason:

Refund shipping fees if:

- wrong item sent
- damaged item delivered
- defective product verified
- incomplete shipment caused return

Do not usually refund shipping fees if:

- customer changed mind
- size did not fit
- customer no longer wanted the product

unless local law or promotion states otherwise.

18.3 Return Shipping Fees

These may be:

- free
- deducted from refund
- customer-paid
depending on region, campaign, and reason for return.

18.4 COD Orders

Refunds for cash on delivery may require:

- bank account details
 - UPI details
 - wallet transfer
 - store credit where accepted by local policy
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19. Exchange Rules

19.1 Size Exchange

Allowed within policy window if:

- inventory exists
- product is in eligible condition
- exchange is for same product family where required

19.2 Color / Style Exchange

May be allowed only through:

- return and repurchase
- supervised exception
- inventory-linked exchange flow

19.3 Price Difference Handling

If exchange is permitted for a higher-value item:

- customer pays the difference

If exchanged for a lower-value item:

- refund/store credit issued for the balance per regional rules

19.4 Out-of-Stock Exchange

Offer one of:

- refund
 - alternate size or color
 - store credit
 - waitlist if operationally supported
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20. Wrong Item / Missing Item / Incomplete Order

If a customer received the wrong item or an incomplete shipment:

Agents must:

- apologize and reassure
- verify order and shipment contents
- request photos where needed
- confirm whether the customer wants refund, replacement, or exchange
- prioritize fast resolution

Common resolution paths:

- replacement without waiting for return in low-value cases
 - return pickup and replacement
 - partial refund for missing item
 - full replacement for pair mismatch or single-shoe issue
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21. Damaged on Arrival (DOA)

DOA claims should ideally be reported within **48 to 72 hours** of delivery.

Required evidence may include:

- photos of shipping box
- photos of product
- label and barcode images
- unboxing video where regionally required or customary

If verified, resolution may include:

- full refund
 - replacement
 - exchange
 - partial refund for minor damage if customer agrees
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22. Warranty Evaluation Process

For warranty claims, agents should gather:

- order number
- date of purchase
- usage duration
- sports activity/use case
- photos from multiple angles
- close-up of defect
- sole and upper view
- product label/size tag
- short video where helpful

Agents should determine whether the issue is:

- manufacturing defect
- usage damage
- wear and tear
- sizing/comfort dissatisfaction
- environmental damage

If uncertain, send to Quality Review or Escalations.

23. Service Recovery Options

Depending on case strength and customer history, approved remedies may include:

- full refund
- replacement
- size exchange
- store credit
- partial refund
- goodwill discount code
- one-time exception approval

Agents should not overuse goodwill credits for clear misuse cases.

24. Abuse Prevention and Fraud Indicators

Potential abuse indicators include:

- repeated claims from same account
- inconsistent story and images
- excessive return frequency
- claim after prolonged heavy usage
- serial “defect” claims on performance shoes after sports season
- item mismatch in return
- suspected counterfeit substitution
- manipulated invoice or screenshot

If abuse is suspected:

- do not accuse customer directly
 - state claim requires additional review
 - escalate to Risk or Supervisor
 - document evidence carefully
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25. Escalation Matrix

25.1 Agent-Level Resolution

Agent may resolve directly:

- standard return within window
- size exchange with inventory available
- wrong item claim clearly evidenced
- DOA with complete proof
- low-value accessory replacement

25.2 Supervisor Escalation

Supervisor review required for:

- out-of-policy return exception
- used item return request
- partial refund negotiations
- repeated complaints
- social media risk cases
- VIP customer recovery decisions

25.3 Quality / Product Team Escalation

Required for:

- disputed manufacturing defect
- repeated same-SKU defect complaints
- premium product failures
- safety-related complaints
- large-batch issue signals

25.4 Legal / Compliance Escalation

Required for:

- statutory rights disputes
 - injury claims
 - allergy or medical damage complaints
 - regulator threats
 - chargeback patterns involving policy allegations
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26. Special Cases

26.1 Gift Orders

If gift receipt or order lookup is available:

- allow exchange
- refund may be converted to store credit where needed

26.2 Promotional Bundles

If one part of a bundle is returned:

- refund may be recalculated based on bundle mechanics
- free gift may need to be returned if tied to order value threshold

26.3 Limited Edition / Hype Releases

These may be:

- final sale
- exchange-only for defects
- subject to authentication and stricter review

26.4 Customized Products

Not returnable for:

- preference
- fit dissatisfaction after confirmed custom order

Returnable only if:

- wrong customization delivered
 - product has a manufacturing defect
 - customization differs from approved order
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27. Regional Pickup and Return Logistics

Depending on region, return handling may include:

- doorstep reverse pickup
- carrier drop-off
- locker drop
- self-ship with reimbursement
- no pickup in remote areas

If self-ship is authorized:

- provide exact shipping instructions
 - communicate reimbursement cap if applicable
 - advise customer to keep receipt and tracking proof
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28. Refund Timelines

Typical timelines after return approval or receipt:

- instant approval cases: 2–5 business days
- after warehouse quality check: 5–10 business days
- bank processing delays: additional 2–7 business days
- COD/manual refund: may take longer based on verification

Agents should never promise an exact same-day refund unless system-supported.

29. Customer Communication Principles

Agents must:

- listen fully before quoting policy
- acknowledge inconvenience first
- avoid sounding defensive
- explain what is covered and what is not
- give next steps clearly
- avoid legalistic wording unless necessary
- document all commitments precisely

Preferred tone:

- calm
- helpful
- direct
- confident

Avoid:

- blaming the customer
 - vague promises
 - unsupported exceptions
 - contradicting written policy
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30. Suggested Call Handling Language

30.1 For Eligible Return

“Thanks for explaining that. I’ve checked your order, and this item is eligible for return under our policy. I’ll now guide you through the next steps.”

30.2 For Size Exchange

“I can help with a size exchange, subject to stock availability. Let me first check the requested size and set up the exchange option for you.”

30.3 For Warranty Review

“This looks like a case we should review under our product warranty process. I’ll need a few photos and order details so we can assess it correctly and offer the best resolution.”

30.4 For Non-Covered Wear and Tear

“I understand the concern. Based on the images and usage details, this appears to be wear from regular use rather than a manufacturing defect, so it would fall outside warranty coverage. Let me still check whether there is any goodwill option available.”

30.5 For Out-of-Policy Request

“The item is outside our standard return window, but I’ll review whether an exception can be considered based on the circumstances.”

31. Documentation Requirements for Every Case

Agents must log:

- order number
- product SKU
- issue type
- date delivered
- date reported
- product condition
- customer ask
- photos/videos received
- resolution offered
- exception reason if applicable
- escalation notes

Good documentation is mandatory for auditability and repeat-contact prevention.

32. Quality Feedback Loop

Customer service should regularly flag:

- recurring defect patterns
- misleading size chart issues
- packaging damage trends
- courier mishandling routes
- high-return SKUs
- misleading product page descriptions
- suspicious seller/channel issues

Monthly review should be shared with:

- quality team
- ecommerce operations

- merchandising
 - product team
 - logistics partners
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33. Policy Exceptions

Exceptions may be granted in cases such as:

- first-time loyal customer issue
- medical or accessibility-related special circumstances
- delayed delivery causing missed return window
- product page or size guide error
- confirmed courier mishandling
- system failure affecting return creation

All exceptions must be logged with reason code.

34. Internal Decision Guide

Approve quickly when:

- clear defect
- wrong item
- damaged delivery
- unused return within policy
- size exchange with stock

Review carefully when:

- used product
- claim near warranty end
- comfort complaint after extended wear
- no packaging
- no invoice but order likely genuine

Escalate when:

- legal risk
- injury claim
- repeat abuse signal
- cross-border issue

- premium or limited-edition dispute
 - policy conflict with local law
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35. Example Resolution Principles by Complaint Type

“The shoes are uncomfortable after wearing them outside.”

Likely not warranty unless defect exists.

Offer policy-based return only if still eligible and condition qualifies.

“The sole came off after three weeks.”

Potential warranty case. Gather photos and usage details. Likely covered if no misuse.

“I ordered size 9 but got size 8.”

Eligible for exchange or replacement at no customer cost.

“The product looks slightly different from website color.”

Assess material variation and listing accuracy. If materially misleading, allow return.

“I wore these daily for six months and now the grip is gone.”

Likely wear and tear. Not warranty-covered.

“My football boots tore on concrete.”

Not covered if product was used outside intended playing surface.

36. Final Policy Principle

VelocityX should be generous where the brand is at fault, balanced where facts are mixed, and firm where misuse or wear and tear is clear.

The purpose of this policy is not just to say yes or no. It is to help every agent reach the right answer consistently, protect the customer experience, and uphold brand trust.

